TECHNOLOGY ETHICS • COMPLETE STUDY NOTES

Set 1: Ethics and Ethical Theories

What Ethics Is, Kantianism, Utilitarianism, Relativism, Ethical Egoism, Social Contract & Divine Command Theories

PART 1

Ethics and ethical theories

2 sections, about 1 h 45 min of reading.

What ethics is, Kantianism and utilitarianism

~1 h 05 min to read | High priority | 16 questions

Source: Set 1, slides 1-20 (Introduction to Ethics, after Baase, *A Gift of Fire*, and Quinn, *Ethics for the Information Age*). Relativism, egoism, social contract and divine command theory are in the next section.

> **How to use this section.** Ethics theory is the most keyword-heavy part of the course. For each theory you need three things: the definition in slide wording, the arguments for and against in slide wording, and one worked example. Each topic ends with a "say it like this" sentence and a cloze drill. Learn those sentences word for word.

What is ethics?

The slides open with the course title: Introduction to Ethics. The sources are two textbooks, Baase (*A Gift of Fire*) and Quinn (*Ethics for the Information Age*). You can cite them as the course texts.

The slide definition is short. **Ethics is a branch of philosophy that studies principles relating to "right" and "wrong".** Because it is a branch of philosophy, it works by argument and reasoning, not by experiment or measurement.

Ethics tries to answer four questions. Know all four, because they show what the subject covers:

1. "What do people think is right?" This is a descriptive question: it asks what people actually believe.
2. "What does 'do the right thing' mean?" This asks for the meaning of the phrase itself.
3. "How should people act?" This is a prescriptive question: it asks what people ought to do.
4. "What rules or laws should we have?" This links ethics to law and policy.

The goal of ethics

The slide gives the goal in one line: **to help people to make moral decisions.** Two further points qualify it.

- Ethics **assumes that people are rational and free to choose how they will act.** If a person could not reason, or could not choose, it would make no sense to hold them to ethical standards. A falling rock is

not unethical; a free, thinking engineer who ignores a safety defect can be.

- Ethics **can be used to describe how people do act, or how people should act.** The first use is descriptive (what is). The second is normative or prescriptive (what ought to be). Exam questions usually care about the second.

Ethics, morals, values and law

Past papers (2017 Q1 and 2016 Q1) ask you to define and distinguish these terms. The slides give only the definition of ethics. The rest below is built from the lecturer's solution files and general knowledge, so treat it as beyond the slides.

Exact wording. 2017 Q1:

> EXAM WORDING
> Give clear definitions of the following terms as they relate to the course Technology, Ethics & Human Rights

: Ethics (2 marks), Morals (2 marks), Values (2 marks), Law (2 marks), Utilitarianism (4 marks), Deontology (4 marks), Teleology (4 marks), Consequentialist theory (5 marks). 2016 Q1 (12 marks):

> EXAM WORDING
> Differentiate between the following: a. Values and Morals, b. Ethics and Morality, c. Profession and Occupation, d. Ethics of teleology and deontology.

Term	Meaning
Ethics	A branch of philosophy that studies principles relating to right and wrong. Also used for the rules a group or profession sets for itself (professional ethics, medical ethics).
Morals (morality)	Principles of right and wrong behaviour that are generally accepted by society, shaped by religion, culture and personal belief. beyond the slides
Values	The beliefs and standards that an individual or a society considers important or desirable. They are general and wide. beyond the slides
Law	Rules of conduct made by a government and enforced by punishment. beyond the slides The full ethics versus law comparison is in section 6.

Ethics versus morality. Ethics is the study of, and reasoning about, right and wrong, and it is applied to a particular context such as a profession. Morality is the actual personal or social conduct and belief about right and wrong. In short: morality is the practice, ethics is the study of the practice.

Values versus morals. Values are broad: anything a person prizes, such as honesty, wealth, loyalty or comfort. Morals are narrower: they are the values that are turned into rules about right and wrong conduct. Every moral rests on a value, but not every value is a moral.

Q: **2017 Q1 · 2 marks each** Give clear definitions of the following terms as they relate to the course Technology, Ethics and Human Rights: (i) Ethics (ii) Morals (iii) Values (iv) Law.

Q: **2016 Q1a, b · CAT 2021-22 Q1.1, 1.2** Differentiate between the following: (a) Values and morals. (b) Ethics and morality.

Q: **2014/15 Q4a · 2011/12 Q1a · 2 marks each, 8 marks** Define the following terms: (i) Virtue (ii) Conscience (iii) Ethical dilemma (iv) Intrinsic good.

Q: **CAT 1 2015 Q1a-c · 5, 2 and 3 marks (scan order unclear)** (a) Of what value is the study of the human person in Ethics? (b) Distinguish between human acts and acts of man. (c) Of what value is this distinction in Ethics?

MARKER WORDS: WHAT ETHICS IS

Say it like this:

> Ethics is a **branch of philosophy** that studies **principles relating to right and wrong**. Its goal is **to help people to make moral decisions**, and it assumes that people are **rational and free to choose** how they act.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
branch of philosophy	defining ethics	MUST
principles of right and wrong	defining ethics or morals	MUST
moral decisions	stating the goal of ethics	MUST
rational and free to choose	stating the assumption behind ethics	SHOULD
how people do act / how people should act	saying ethics can be descriptive or prescriptive	SHOULD
generally accepted by society	defining morals	MUST

▶ **Recall drill: write the definition from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Define ethics.
A branch of philosophy that studies principles relating to "right" and "wrong".

What is the goal of ethics?
To help people to make moral decisions.

The four questions ethics seeks to address.
What do people think is right? What does "do the right thing" mean? How should people act? What rules or laws should we have?

What does ethics assume about people?
That people are rational and free to choose how they will act.

Why study ethics? Negative and positive arguments

Slides 4 and 5 are a debate. First come the arguments that studying ethics is pointless (introduced by "But ..."). Then come the replies. Know both sides, because an exam question can ask you to justify the study of ethics.

Negative arguments (against studying ethics)

- **There are no universal norms of right and wrong.** Nothing is right or wrong for everyone everywhere.
- **Ethical debates are disagreeable and pointless.** The slide gives the reasons behind this:
  - We are all well-meaning and intelligent people, so why argue?
  - Each person may decide right and wrong for himself or herself: "What's right for you may not be right for me."
  - We can disagree on moral issues, and that is the end of it.

This view is what the later theories of subjective and cultural relativism formalise (see relativism).

Positive arguments (why we should study ethics)

- **Not everyone can do what they want.** We must respect other people and their values. Living with others limits our freedom.
- **"Common wisdom" is not always adequate.** What we picked up from family and friends may fail in new situations. We need to be prepared to face future ethical decisions, for example the new problems technology keeps creating.
- **Everybody shares the "core values" of life.** This answers the claim that there are no universal norms. People disagree on many details but agree on basics such as not killing, not stealing and being honest.
- **Ethics provides bases to make the best rational decisions.** It gives you reasons you can defend, not just feelings.

Key point. Each positive argument answers a negative one. "No universal norms" is answered by "everybody shares core values". "Each person decides for themselves" is answered by "not everyone can do what they want; we must respect others". "Debate is pointless" is answered by "ethics gives bases for rational decisions".

Q: Practice · 4 marks **Some people say that studying ethics is pointless because right and wrong are personal opinions. Give two arguments against this view.**

MARKER WORDS: WHY STUDY ETHICS

Say it like this:

> We study ethics because **not everyone can do what they want** and must **respect other people and their values**, because **common wisdom is not always adequate**, because **everybody shares the core values of life**, and because ethics provides **bases to make the best rational decisions**.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
universal norms	stating the negative argument	SHOULD
respect other people and their values	arguing that freedom has limits	SHOULD
common wisdom	saying why intuition is not enough	SHOULD
core values	answering "there are no universal norms"	SHOULD
rational decisions	giving the main benefit of ethics	SHOULD

▶ **Recall drill: write the sentence from memory, then click each blank to check**

Ethical theories and Laudon's three questions, six answers

Ethical theory is not new. There are **approximately 2,000 years of organized literature concerned with ethics**, and many famous philosophers have contributed: **Socrates, Plato, Aristotle, Kant**, and others. With so many theories, Kenneth Laudon (1995) sorted them by asking **three questions, each with two answers: "three questions, six answers"**. Any given theory can be placed by saying how it answers each question.

Question	Answer 1	Answer 2
1. What is "goodness"?	Phenomenologist	Positivist
2. What does acting ethically mean?	Deontologist	Teleologist
3. What is the scope of morality?	Collectivist	Individualist

Question one: what is "goodness"?

- **Answer 1, the phenomenologist.** Goodness is a higher order, and it is given. One must understand the abstract concepts of right and wrong and act accordingly. Goodness exists independently of us and we discover it.
- **Answer 2, the positivist.** Goodness is whatever we make of it. We have to derive ethical principles for ourselves according to our observations of the real world. Goodness is built from experience.

Question two: what does acting ethically mean?

- **Answer 1, the deontologist.** Acting ethically means respecting one's duties and obligations. Each single act is itself good or bad, regardless of its consequences.
- **Answer 2, the teleologist.** Acting ethically means acting in such a way that the outcome is good. An act can be judged only by its consequences. No act is a priori good (no act is good before and apart from its results).

This is the pair that exams ask about most. Deontology looks at the act and the duty. Teleology looks at the result. The word "deontology" comes from the Greek *deon*, duty. "Teleology" comes from *telos*, end or goal. beyond the slides

Question three: what is the scope of morality?

- **Answer 1, the collectivist.** Ethical standards make sense only if they equally apply to everyone.
- **Answer 2, the individualist.** Nobody should be committed to accepting ethical standards. Individuals should set their own rules through self-analysis and reflection.

The list of ethical systems

Slide 10 lists the ethical systems the course covers:

1. Kantianism
2. Utilitarianism
3. Ethical egoism
4. Subjective relativism
5. Cultural relativism
6. Social contract theory
7. Divine command theory

The first two are in this section. The remaining five are in section 2. Rough placement against Laudon: Kantianism is deontological and collectivist (one rule for everyone). Utilitarianism is teleological. Subjective

relativism is individualist. beyond the slides

Teleology, deontology and consequentialism in exam language

Past papers ask for definitions of teleology, deontology, utilitarianism and "consequentialist theory". The slides define the first two inside Laudon's question two, and say utilitarianism is "a consequentialist theory". Use these definitions.

- **Deontology (duty ethics).** Acting ethically means respecting one's duties and obligations. Each single act is itself good or bad, regardless of its consequences. Example: Kantianism.
- **Teleology.** Acting ethically means acting so that the outcome is good. An act is judged only by its consequences. No act is a priori good.
- **Consequentialist theory.** A theory that decides right and wrong by the consequences of an act. Teleological theories are consequentialist. Example: utilitarianism. The solution files treat "teleological" and "consequentialist" as the same family.

Typical problems of consequentialist theories (QB E1): the consequences are hard to predict and measure; they must all be put on one scale; and they can justify sacrificing a minority, so they may not respect individual rights. These match the criticisms of utilitarianism below.

Q: QB E2 · 6 marks · 2016 Q1d · CAT 2021-22 Q1.4 **Characterize and distinguish between consequentialist ethical theories and deontological ethical theories. Give one example of each.**

Q: 2017 Q1 · 4, 4, 4, 5 marks **Define: Utilitarianism (4 marks). Deontology (4 marks). Teleology (4 marks). Consequentialist theory (5 marks).**

Q: QB E1 · 6 marks **What is the defining characteristic of consequentialist theories in ethics? Identify at least two problems with consequentialist theories.**

MARKER WORDS: LAUDON, TELEOLOGY AND DEONTOLOGY

Say it like this:

> **Deontology** says acting ethically means **respecting one's duties and obligations**, so each act is good or bad **regardless of its consequences**. **Teleology** says acting ethically means **acting so that the outcome is good**, so an act is judged **only by its consequences** and **no act is a priori good**.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
duties and obligations	defining deontology	**SHOULD**
regardless of its consequences	contrasting deontology with teleology	**SHOULD**
outcome is good	defining teleology	**SHOULD**
judged only by its consequences	defining teleology or consequentialism	**SHOULD**
a priori	explaining teleology	**SHOULD**
three questions, six answers	naming Laudon's classification	**SHOULD**
phenomenologist / positivist	answering "what is goodness"	**SHOULD**
collectivist / individualist	answering "scope of morality"	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the sentence from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Laudon's three questions.
What is "goodness"? What does acting ethically mean? What is the scope of morality?

Laudon's six answers.
Phenomenologist and positivist; deontologist and teleologist; collectivist and individualist.

Phenomenologist view of goodness.
It is a higher order, and it is given. One must understand the abstract concepts of right and wrong, and act accordingly.

Positivist view of goodness.
It is whatever we make of it. We have to derive ethical principles for ourselves according to our observations of the real world.

Deontologist: what does acting ethically mean?
Respecting one's duties and obligations. Each single act is itself good or bad, regardless of its consequences.

Teleologist: what does acting ethically mean?
Acting in such a way that the outcome is good. An act can be judged only by its consequences. No act is a priori good.

Collectivist and individualist views of the scope of morality.
Collectivist: ethical standards make sense only if they equally apply to everyone. Individualist: nobody should be committed to accepting ethical standards; individuals set their own rules through self-analysis and reflection.

The seven ethical systems on the slide.
Kantianism; utilitarianism; ethical egoism; subjective relativism; cultural relativism; social contract theory; divine command theory.

Kantianism

Kantianism is attributed to **Immanuel Kant (1724-1804)**. It is the standard example of a deontological theory.

- It focuses on **the rightness of moral rules ("good will")**. What counts is acting from a good will, doing the right thing because it is right.
- It **disregards emotional feelings and consequences**. How you feel, and what happens afterwards, do not decide whether the act was right.
- It is **founded on the view that all people are fundamentally rational beings**, who can derive moral rules from the logic of the situation and act according to the rules.

Kant's criteria

To test a rule, ask two questions:

1. **Can the rule be universally applied to everyone?** Imagine everybody followed it. If that is impossible or self-defeating, the rule is invalid. This is universalisation (the "universalizability" test).
2. **Does the rule treat people as ends, not means?** People must be respected as persons with their own purposes. They must not be used only as tools to get what you want.

A rule must pass both tests to be a valid moral rule. These are two forms of what Kant called the categorical imperative. **beyond the slides**

Examples: valid and invalid rules

- **Valid rules:** "Do not kill", "Do not lie", "Do not steal", "Follow the laws". Each can be applied to everyone without contradiction, and each respects people as ends.
- **An invalid rule:** "Get this work done, whatever it takes." It fails because "whatever it takes" would allow lying, cutting safety corners or using colleagues as mere means to the deadline. It cannot be universalised and it treats people as means.

Worked example: promise-breaking

The slide asks: *can a person in an extreme situation make a promise with the intention of breaking it later?* Suppose someone is desperate for a loan and will only get it by promising to repay, though they know they will not. Follow the analysis step by step.

1. **Proposed rule:** "I may make promises with the intention of later breaking them."
2. **Universalise the rule:** "Everyone may make and break promises."
3. **Test it:** If everyone did this, nobody would believe any promise. A promise only works if people believe it. So the rule would make promises unbelievable.
4. **Contradiction:** This contradicts the person's own desire to have their promise believed. The lie works only because most people keep promises. A rule that destroys the thing it depends on cannot be a universal rule.
5. **Conclusion:** The rule is flawed. The answer is "No."

Critiques of Kantianism

Arguments for	Arguments against
It is rational.	It allows no exceptions to moral rules.
It produces universal moral guidelines.	Sometimes no rule adequately characterizes an action.
It treats all persons as moral equals.	There is no way to resolve a conflict between rules.

Examples revisited: the problems in action

- **Rule: "Do not kill."** What if it is on a battlefield? A soldier, or a person defending their family, may have to kill. The rule allows no exception, so a strict Kantian is stuck. This is "no exceptions to moral rules".
- **Rule: "Do not lie."** What if not lying will lead to bad consequences? Telling a murderer where his intended victim hides is a classic case. Kantianism ignores consequences, so it still says "do not lie". This also shows a conflict between rules: "do not lie" against "do not kill" or "protect life", with no way to rank them.

> **Watch out.** Do not write that Kantianism "ignores people". It ignores *consequences and feelings*. It treats all persons as moral equals and as ends. Say "universal" and "ends, not means" every time.

Q: **QB E4 · 6 marks · 2018 Morality c** "Kant's idea of universalization does not work in practice." Discuss.

Q: **2018 Morality c** How relevant is Kant's universalizability principle today?

MARKER WORDS: KANTIANISM

Say it like this:

> Kantianism, attributed to **Immanuel Kant**, is a deontological theory that focuses on the **rightness of moral rules (good will)** and **disregards feelings and consequences**. A rule is valid if it **can be universally applied to everyone** and **treats people as ends, not means**.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
universally applied to everyone	stating the first criterion	**SHOULD**
ends, not means	stating the second criterion	**MUST**
good will	saying what Kant focuses on	**SHOULD**
rational beings	giving the basis of Kantianism	**SHOULD**
disregards consequences	contrasting with utilitarianism	**SHOULD**
no exceptions to moral rules	criticising Kantianism	**SHOULD**
conflict between rules	criticising Kantianism	**SHOULD**
moral equals	praising Kantianism	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the sentence from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Kantianism: who and what does it focus on?
Attributed to Immanuel Kant (1724-1804). Focus on the rightness of moral rules ("good will"); disregard emotional feelings and consequences.

What is Kantianism founded on?
The view that all people are fundamentally rational beings, and can derive moral rules from the logic of the situation and act according to the rules.

Kant's two criteria.
Can the rule be universally applied to everyone? Does the rule treat people as ends, not means?

Arguments for Kantianism.
Rational; produces universal moral guidelines; treats all persons as moral equals.

Arguments against Kantianism.
It allows no exceptions to moral rules; sometimes no rule adequately characterizes an action; there is no way to resolve a conflict between rules.

Valid rules and an invalid rule on the slide.
Valid: "Do not kill", "Do not lie", "Do not steal", "Follow the laws". Invalid: "Get this work done, whatever it takes."

Utilitarianism

Utilitarianism is a consequentialist theory. It decides whether an act or rule is "right" depending on whether it results in the **increase of the aggregate "happiness" (or "utilities")**. In plain words: add up the good and bad effects on everyone affected. The right choice is the one with the largest total good. The best-known founders are Jeremy Bentham and John Stuart Mill. beyond the slides

Act and rule utilitarianism

- **Act utilitarianism:** judging the benefits of a single act. Each act is weighed on its own.
- **Rule utilitarianism:** judging the benefits of all actions that follow the rule. You ask what happens if everybody follows this rule, and choose the rule that gives the best total result.

	Act utilitarianism	Rule utilitarianism
What is judged	A single act	A rule, by all the actions that follow it
Question asked	Does this act raise total happiness?	Would following this rule raise total happiness?
Flexibility	High; every case is new	Lower; rules give stability beyond the slides

Example 1: replacing a curvy highway

Problem. A state wants to replace a curvy stretch of highway with a straighter one. To build it, 150 houses would have to be removed, and some wildlife habitat would be destroyed.

Analysis. Add up the costs and the benefits.

- **Costs: $31 million.** This covers compensation for the homeowners and for the wildlife habitat, plus the construction cost.
- **Benefits: $39 million** in savings in driving costs.

Conclusion. Benefits exceed costs ($39 million against $31 million, a net gain of $8 million). It is a good action. Notice the method: turn everything, even homes and habitat, into a single money scale, and compare totals. That is what the later critique ("requires aggregating all consequences on a single scale") attacks.

Example 2: the Blaster worm and the Nachi worm

Background. In August 2003, the Blaster worm infected thousands of Windows computers. Soon after, someone wrote a "good" worm called Nachi. Nachi did four things:

1. It took control of a vulnerable computer.
2. It located and destroyed copies of Blaster.
3. It downloaded a software patch to fix the security problem.
4. It used the computer as a launching pad to try to "infect" other vulnerable PCs.

Proposed rule. "If I can write a helpful worm that removes a harmful worm from infected computers and shields them from future attacks, I should do so."

Evaluation. The slide tests the proposed rule: what happens if everyone who can write such a worm follows it?

- **Who would benefit:** people who do not keep their systems updated. Their machines get cleaned and patched without effort.
- **Who would be harmed:**
  - People who use networks, because the worm's spreading traffic slows and clogs them.
  - People whose computers are invaded by buggy anti-worms: an uninvited program may damage their systems.
  - System administrators, who must clean up and cope with the extra traffic and unplanned changes.

Conclusion. Harm outweighs benefits. The action is wrong. Even a helpful motive does not rescue the act, because utilitarianism judges by the total of consequences. If every programmer who thought their worm was good released it, networks would be flooded.

Critiques of utilitarianism

Arguments for	Arguments against
Focuses on practical "goodness".	Requires aggregating all consequences on a single scale.
Comprehensive; can include exceptional situations.	Does not recognize or respect individual rights. (A minority group could be sacrificed for the greater happiness of the majority.)

Explaining the criticisms.

- **Single scale.** Happiness, lives, money, habitat and privacy are different kinds of things. To add them you must give each a number, and the numbers are arguable. How much is a house worth against a wildlife habitat? The highway example does this with dollars.
- **Individual rights.** If the total is what counts, harming one person or a small group is acceptable whenever the majority gains more. The 150 families lose their homes, but the gain is larger overall. This is the main contrast with Kantianism, which treats every person as an end.
- A third criticism often cited, which is not on the slides: the future consequences cannot be predicted reliably. `beyond the slides`

Q: `2016 Q5A · 4 marks` In your own words describe the central tenet of utilitarianism.

Q: `2016 Q5B · 6 marks · 2021-22 exam Q1d` Describe THREE frequently cited criticisms of utilitarian ethics. [Two drawbacks in the 2021-22 version.]

Q: `2016 Q4A · 8 marks · CAT 2021-22 Q3b · [reconstructed from garbled scan]` Construct two utilitarian-style arguments supporting, and two opposing, strong property rights over computer software.

Q: `2018 Morality a, b` (a) Define utilitarianism and absolutism and discuss the failings of each principle. (b) Utilitarianism is largely driven by the definition and measure of utility. Discuss the logic behind this evaluation criterion and explain how this might affect people.

MARKER WORDS: UTILITARIANISM

Say it like this:

> Utilitarianism is a **consequentialist theory** that decides whether an act or rule is right depending on whether it results in an **increase of aggregate happiness (utilities)**. **Act utilitarianism** judges the benefits of a single act; **rule utilitarianism** judges the benefits of all actions that follow the rule.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
consequentialist theory	defining utilitarianism	**MUST**
aggregate happiness / utilities	stating the test of rightness	**MUST**
benefits exceed costs	concluding a utilitarian calculation	**SHOULD**
harm outweighs benefits	concluding that an act is wrong	**SHOULD**
single scale	criticising utilitarianism	**SHOULD**
individual rights	criticising utilitarianism	**MUST**
minority group sacrificed	illustrating the rights problem	**SHOULD**
comprehensive; exceptional situations	praising utilitarianism	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the sentence from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Define utilitarianism.
A consequentialist theory. It decides whether an act or rule is "right" depending on whether it results in the increase of the aggregate "happiness" (or "utilities").

Act utilitarianism.
Judging the benefits of a single act.

Rule utilitarianism.
Judging the benefits of all actions that follow the rule.

Arguments for utilitarianism.
Focuses on practical "goodness"; comprehensive, can include exceptional situations.

Arguments against utilitarianism.
Requires aggregating all consequences on a single scale; does not recognize or respect individual rights (a minority group could be sacrificed for the greater happiness of the majority).

Highway example figures.
150 houses removed; costs $31 million; benefits $39 million in driving cost savings; benefits exceed costs, so it is a good action.

Who benefits and who is harmed in the Nachi worm example?
Benefit: people who do not keep their systems updated. Harmed: people who use networks; people whose computers are invaded by buggy anti-worms; system administrators. Harm outweighs benefits, so the action is wrong.

Virtue ethics and absolutism beyond the slides

The slides teach two theory families, duty (Kant) and consequences (utilitarianism). Past papers (2017 Q4A, 2021-22 Q2A and Q4C) also ask for a third, virtue ethics, and 2018 asks for absolutism. They are examined, so learn them in compact form.

Exact wording. 2017 Q4A (6 marks):

> EXAM WORDING
> What would you advise Holger Hjortsvang, Max Blankenzee and Robert Bruder to do after the response by the managers? Apply two out of the following three ethical theories (deontological ethics, consequentialist ethics, and virtue ethics) to decide how to act.

2021-22 exam Q2A (marks not printed):

> EXAM WORDING
> Describe the differentiate theories associated with morality.

2021-22 exam Q4C (marks not printed):

> EXAM WORDING
> Explain four virtues relevant for an engineer doing tests like those James wished to undertake. What actions are supported by these virtues?

2018 Q5, Morality (a) (Q5 is 20 marks; part marks not printed):

> EXAM WORDING

> Define utilitarianism and absolutism and discuss the failings of each principle.

Virtue ethics

- **Founder.** Associated with the Greek philosopher Aristotle.
- **Focus.** The **character of the moral agent**, not rules (deontology) and not outcomes (consequentialism). It develops virtuous character traits such as courage, honesty, compassion, justice and integrity.
- **Guiding question.** Not "what rule applies?" or "what gives the best total?" but "**what would a good, responsible person do?**" or "which option leads me to act as a responsible person?"
- **Example.** A person who consistently acts with honesty and integrity is virtuous, whatever the particular outcome.
- **Weakness.** It gives little concrete guidance when virtues conflict (honesty against loyalty), and different cultures prize different virtues.

Q: **2021-22 exam Q2A · 2017 Q4A** **Describe the different theories associated with morality (deontological, consequentialist and virtue ethics).**

Absolutism

Absolutism is the view that some acts are always right or always wrong, whatever the consequences, culture or circumstances. Rules such as "do not kill", "do not lie" and "do not steal" admit no exceptions. Kantianism is the standard example, and absolutism is the opposite of relativism (section 2) and of consequentialism. Its failings, in slide wording for Kantianism: **it allows no exceptions to moral rules**, and **there is no way to resolve a conflict between rules**.

MARKER WORDS: VIRTUE ETHICS AND ABSOLUTISM

Say it like this:

> **Virtue ethics** focuses on the **character of the moral agent** and the cultivation of virtues such as courage, honesty and compassion, **rather than on rules or consequences**. **Absolutism** holds that some acts are **always right or wrong regardless of consequences**.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
character of the moral agent	defining virtue ethics	**SHOULD**
cultivation of virtues	defining virtue ethics	**SHOULD**
rather than rules or consequences	contrasting it with the other two theories	**SHOULD**
always right or wrong	defining absolutism	**SHOULD**
no exceptions	criticising absolutism	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the sentence from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Define virtue.
A good, settled quality of character that disposes a person to act rightly (beyond the slides).

Define conscience.
A person's inner sense or faculty of judging whether an act is right or wrong (beyond the slides).

Define intrinsic good.
Something good in itself, for its own sake, not only as a means to something else (beyond the slides).

Define virtue ethics.
A theory that focuses on the character of the moral agent and the cultivation of virtues such as courage, honesty and compassion, rather than on rules or consequences.

Define absolutism.
The view that some acts are always right or always wrong, whatever the consequences or culture.

The four cardinal virtues.
Prudence, justice, fortitude (courage), temperance.

Human act versus act of man.
A human act is done knowingly and freely and can be morally assessed. An act of man (reflex, digestion) happens without knowledge or free choice and cannot.

Applying the theories: the FANX case (James)

This 2021-22 exam question (Q4; marks not printed in the solution file) tests the three theories on one case. Retold in full:

The case. James is an engineer at AERO, a maker of aero-engines. He is responsible for testing the company's new engine, the FANX, and is partway through crucial reliability tests. His boss Bill tells him to finish the test report within a week because an important potential customer is visiting next week and wants to see the first test reports. James refuses: he cannot finish in a week and needs more tests to understand the engine's reliability. Bill orders him to abandon the planned tests and write the report now, with more tests later. Bill adds that if James refuses, Eric will write it. James objects that Eric does not know the tests and cannot write a sound report. James then asks Eric, who agrees with Bill and will write it if asked.

Q: **2021-22 exam Q4 A-D** **(A) Suppose James the next day decides to follow Bill's order, finishing the report at once and abandoning the other tests. Can this choice be justified in utilitarian terms? Explain why or why not. (B) What should James do if he tries to apply Kant's categorical imperative to this situation? (C) Explain four virtues relevant for an engineer doing tests like those James wished to undertake. What actions are supported by these virtues? (D) Which moral framework (theory) is best suited to this moral problem? Justify your answer.**

MARKER WORDS: APPLYING THEORIES TO A CASE

Say it like this:

> The **utilitarian** weighs the **consequences for all stakeholders**; the **Kantian** asks whether the rule can be **universally applied** and treats people as **ends, not means**; the **virtue ethicist** asks what a person of **integrity, diligence, prudence and professionalism** would do.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
all stakeholders	applying utilitarianism to a case	**SHOULD**
short-term benefit, long-term harm	concluding a utilitarian analysis of a rushed job	**SHOULD**
universal law	applying the categorical imperative	**SHOULD**
integrity, diligence, prudence, professionalism	naming engineering virtues	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the sentence from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Four virtues for an engineer testing a product (FANX answer).
Integrity, diligence, prudence, professionalism.

The three theory families examined.
Deontological ethics, consequentialist ethics, virtue ethics.

Kantianism and utilitarianism side by side

Past questions often ask you to apply "two theories" to a case, or to contrast them. Keep this table in your head. The full method for applying them is in section 7.

	Kantianism	Utilitarianism
Type	Deontological (duty)	Consequentialist (teleological)
What decides right	The rule: universal and treats people as ends	Aggregate happiness (utilities)
Consequences	Disregarded	The only thing that counts
Strength	Universal guidelines; all persons moral equals	Practical; handles exceptional situations
Main weakness	No exceptions; conflicts between rules unresolved	Single scale; individual rights not respected
Highway example	Would ask whether removing 150 families treats them as ends	$39 million benefit beats $31 million cost, so build

MARKER WORDS: KANTIANISM VERSUS UTILITARIANISM

Say it like this:

> **Kantianism** is **deontological**: an act is right if the rule can be **universally applied** and treats people as ends, **disregarding consequences**. **Utilitarianism** is **consequentialist**: an act is right if it increases **aggregate happiness**, but it may not respect **individual rights**.

▶ **Recall drill: write the sentence from memory, then click each blank to check**

The other theories are in the next section. Case practice using these two theories is in section 7 and section 8.

Relativism, egoism, social contract and divine command

~40 min to read | Medium priority | 9 questions

Source: Set 1, slides 21-37 (and slide 10 for the list of seven systems)

Slide 10 lists "a few ethical systems": Kantianism, utilitarianism, ethical egoism, subjective relativism, cultural relativism, social contract theory and divine command theory. Kantianism and utilitarianism are taught in section t01. This section covers the other five. Each system is taught the same way: the idea, the arguments for, the arguments against, then a marker block and cards.

The seven systems at a glance

Use this table to place each theory in one line. The five theories without a link are taught in full below the table. The two linked to t01 are included so you can compare all seven.

System	Core idea	Strongest argument for	Strongest argument against
Kantianism (t01)	Right acts follow moral rules out of good will and duty, whatever the outcome.	It is rational, produces universal moral guidelines and treats all persons as moral equals.	Rules can conflict and it has no way to settle which duty wins.
Utilitarianism (t01)	The right act increases the aggregate "happiness" (utilities).	It focuses on practical "goodness" and is comprehensive: it can include exceptional situations.	It can justify harming a minority and the consequences are hard to predict or measure.
Ethical egoism	Each person should act out of long-term self-interest.	Most people already act this way, and each person knows their own interest best.	Some people gain power and abuse it, and many people do not act in their own long-term interest.
Subjective relativism	Each person defines right and wrong: "if I think it is right, it is right".	It gives everyone the right to define "goodness".	It cannot tell "right" from "whatever I want", and we could never judge anyone else.
Cultural relativism	Right and wrong depend on a society's actual moral guidelines, which vary by place and time.	Different social contexts need different guidelines, and it is arrogant for one society to judge another.	It gives no way out for cultures in conflict, and societies in fact share core values.
Social contract	People accept rules, on condition others do too, to enjoy the benefits of social living, centred on natural rights.	It is framed in the language of rights and stops self-interest turning into chaos.	Rights can conflict, and it may be unjust to people who cannot follow the rules.
Divine command	Good acts are those aligned with the will of God, revealed in the holy books.	God is all-good, all-knowing and all-powerful, so his authority is above any human system.	There are many interpretations of God's word, and the holy books do not cover modern technology.

Subjective relativism

The idea (slide 21). There are no universal moral norms. Each person defines right and wrong independently. The slide's one-line summary is: "If I think it is right, then that makes it right." A thief who sincerely believes stealing from a rich man is fine is, on this view, right to steal. A second person who believes stealing is wrong is also right. Nobody is mistaken, because there is no standard outside each person's own opinion.

This theory is also called ethical subjectivism. A past paper (2021-22 exam, Q2C, marks not printed) asks:

> EXAM WORDING
>
> With the aid of examples define the following ethical concepts: 1. Ethical pluralism, 2. Ethical egoism, 3. Ethical relativism, 4. Ethical subjectivism.

For this theory, define it with an example: moral judgments rest on individual feelings, attitudes or opinions and there are no objective moral truths.

Arguments for (slide 22).

- It gives everyone a right to define "goodness".
- It eliminates all further moral debate. If each person's view is right for them, there is nothing left to argue about.

Arguments against (slide 22).

- There is no distinction between doing what is "right" and doing whatever you want.
- We can never judge the acts of another person. Even a murderer's view of his own act would have to be accepted.
- Ethics is not based on reason or principle. It becomes a matter of taste.

> **Key point.** The strongest objection is the first: if "right" just means "what I want", then the word "right" adds nothing and ethics disappears.

MARKER WORDS: SUBJECTIVE RELATIVISM

Say it like this:

> Subjective relativism holds that there are **no universal moral norms** and that **each person defines right and wrong** independently: **"if I think it is right, then that makes it right"**.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
no universal moral norms	defining the theory	**SHOULD**
each person defines right and wrong	defining the theory	**SHOULD**
eliminates all further moral debate	giving an argument for	**SHOULD**
doing whatever you want	criticising it	**SHOULD**
can never judge the acts of another person	criticising it	**SHOULD**
not based on reason or principle	criticising it	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the definition from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Subjective relativism: the idea.
There are no universal moral norms. Each person defines right/wrong independently. "If I think it is right, then that makes it right."

Two arguments for subjective relativism.
Gives everyone a right to define "goodness"; eliminates all further moral debate.

Three arguments against subjective relativism.
No distinction between doing what is "right" and doing whatever you want; we can never judge the acts of another person; ethics is not based on reason or principle.

Cultural relativism

The idea (slide 23). What is "right" and "wrong" depends upon a society's actual moral guidelines. These guidelines vary from place to place and from time to time. A particular action may be right in one society at one time and wrong in another society or at another time. The difference from the previous theory is who

decides: here it is the society, not the individual. Example: polygamy is accepted in some societies and condemned in others, and cultural relativism says each society's rule is right for that society.

Argument for (slide 24). Different social contexts demand different moral guidelines. It is arrogant for one society to judge another.

Arguments against (slide 24).

- It does not explain how moral guidelines are determined. Who or what decides what a society's guideline is?
- It provides no way out for cultures in conflict. If two societies disagree, each is right by its own standard, so there is nothing to settle the dispute.
- Because many practices are acceptable does not mean any cultural practice is acceptable. Variety in morals does not prove that every practice is fine.
- Societies do, in fact, share certain core values, for example a ban on murder, so the claim of total variety is exaggerated.

> **Watch out.** Do not mix up the two relativisms. Subjective relativism: the individual decides. Cultural relativism: the society's actual guidelines decide. The 2021-22 solution file gave "ethical relativism" the definition that moral principles are relative to cultures, societies or individuals, with no universal standards.

MARKER WORDS: CULTURAL RELATIVISM

Say it like this:

> Cultural relativism holds that what is **right and wrong depends upon a society's actual moral guidelines**, which **vary from place to place and from time to time**.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
society's actual moral guidelines	defining the theory	**SHOULD**
vary from place to place and from time to time	explaining the theory	**SHOULD**
different social contexts	giving the argument for	**SHOULD**
arrogant to judge another society	giving the argument for	**SHOULD**
cultures in conflict	criticising it	**SHOULD**
share certain core values	criticising it	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the definition from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Cultural relativism: the idea.
What is "right" and "wrong" depends upon a society's actual moral guidelines. These vary from place to place and from time to time.

The argument for cultural relativism.
Different social contexts demand different moral guidelines; it is arrogant for one society to judge another.

Four arguments against cultural relativism.
Doesn't explain how moral guidelines are determined; provides no way out for cultures in conflict; because many practices are acceptable does not mean any cultural practice is acceptable; societies do, in fact, share certain core values.

Ethical egoism

The idea (slide 25). Each person acts out of self-interest. The slide names Ayn Rand, who wrote "Atlas Shrugged" and "The Fountainhead", as the best-known defender. The focus is your long-term best interest, not whatever you feel like today. Someone who lies and cheats for a quick gain damages his reputation and ends up worse off, so long-term self-interest does not mean grabbing everything now.

The slide then asks the awkward question: what keeps society from falling into anarchy, with everyone screwing everyone? The answer it gives is personal character traits. Under egoism these become important: reputation, trust, reliability, virtue and so on. Egoists keep their promises and deal fairly because other people will then deal with them in future.

Arguments for (slide 26).

- Most people naturally act in their own self-interest.
- Society as a whole benefits when each individual puts self-interest first. The slide's example is capitalism: the baker sells bread out of self-interest, not charity, and the town gets its bread.
- Each individual knows what is in his or her best interest, so he or she should decide.

Arguments against (slide 27).

- Many people do not act in their own long-term best interest (the slide says "Examples..." and leaves them to you: people who smoke, gamble, or take drugs for pleasure now). Other ethical systems might save us from ourselves.
- Some people tend to gain power, and they use their power to get more power.
- Some people are naturally "superior". The weaker people resent the successes of the strong, superior winners.

> **Key point.** The anarchy question is the one examiners like. Answer: egoism is about long-term self-interest, so reputation, trust, reliability and virtue matter. These keep people dealing fairly even without rules.

> **Q:** `2016 Q1B · 8 marks` **Compare and contrast ethical egoism and duty ethics as decision-making frameworks for engineers.**

> **Q:** `2021-22 exam, Q2C · define with an example` **With the aid of examples define the following ethical concepts: ethical pluralism; ethical egoism; ethical relativism; ethical subjectivism. [reconstructed from OCR]**

MARKER WORDS: ETHICAL EGOISM

Say it like this:

> Ethical egoism holds that **each person acts out of self-interest**, with the focus on their **long-term best interest**. What keeps society from **anarchy** is **personal character traits** such as reputation, trust and reliability.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
self-interest	defining or contrasting egoism	**MUST**
long-term best interest	defining egoism or answering the objection that it means selfishness	**SHOULD**
reputation, trust, reliability, virtue	answering the anarchy question	**SHOULD**
society as a whole benefits	giving an argument for (capitalism, the baker)	**SHOULD**
each individual knows what is in his best interest	giving an argument for	**SHOULD**
gain power to get more power	criticising egoism	**SHOULD**
other ethical systems might save us from ourselves	criticising egoism	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the definition from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Ethical egoism: the idea.
Each person acts out of self-interest. Focus on your long-term best interest.

Character traits that become important under egoism.
Reputation, trust, reliability, virtue, etc.

Three arguments for ethical egoism.
Most people naturally act in their own self-interest; society as a whole benefits when each individual puts self-interest first (capitalism: the baker sells bread out of self-interest); each individual knows what is in his best interest, so he should decide.

Three arguments against ethical egoism.
Many people do not act in their own long-term best interest (other ethical systems might save us from ourselves); some people tend to gain power and use it to get more power; some people are naturally "superior" and the weaker resent the strong winners.

Social contract theory

The idea (slide 28). Individuals implicitly accept a "social contract", on the condition that others follow the rules as well. Nobody signs anything. You accept it by living in society and using its benefits.

- Individuals act within a sphere of freedom, as long as the set of rules is respected.
- The social contract rules are established simply to enable everyone the benefits of social living. They centre on respecting natural rights to life, liberty and property.
- Everyone benefits when everyone bears the burden of following certain rules.

Kinds of rights (slide 29). According to John Locke (1632-1704) there are three natural rights: life, liberty and property. The slide gives two other classifications.

Kind of right	Meaning	Example
Negative rights (liberties)	The right to act without interference. Others only have to leave you alone.	Free speech; the right to own property.
Positive rights (claim-rights)	An obligation of some people to provide certain things for others.	The right to health care or education, which someone must pay for.

Negative rights cost others nothing but restraint. Positive rights place a burden on others, so they can clash with someone else's negative rights. That is the source of the "conflicting rights" objection below and of the last discussion questions.

The example (slide 30): Bill's DVD stores. Bill owns a chain of DVD rental stores. He collects information about rentals from customers and sells customer profiles to direct marketing firms. Are Bill's actions wrong? The slide's method is to evaluate rights: Bill's rights versus the customers' rights versus the marketing firms' rights. The key question is who owns the information about the transaction.

beyond the slides A way to work the prompts: Bill can argue the information was created in his shop, on his records, so it is his property and he may sell it. Customers can argue it describes them and their private choices, so it belongs to them and they never agreed to its sale. The marketing firms' claim depends on whether the seller had the right to sell. The answer turns on who owns the data: if customers own it, Bill has broken the contract by taking their property; if the shop owns it, he has not.

Arguments for (slide 31).

- It is framed in the language of rights.
- Without common agreement, rational people may act out of self-interest.
- It provides a clear analysis of certain government actions, for example "those who do not follow the rules will be punished".

Arguments against (slide 31).

- The conflicting rights problem: one person's right can collide with another's, and the theory gives no way to rank them.
- It may be unjust to people who are incapable of following the rules (not deliberately breaking them), such as young children or people with severe mental illness.

Q: **Set 1 slide 36-37 · discussion** **Which of these should be considered legitimate positive rights by our society: a minimum standard of living; housing; health care; education (K-12 or higher); a paying job; two months of vacation each year? Give examples of conflicts between the positive rights of one person and the negative rights of another.**

MARKER WORDS: SOCIAL CONTRACT THEORY

Say it like this:

> Under social contract theory, individuals **implicitly accept a "social contract"**, on the condition that **others follow the rules as well**. The rules enable everyone the **benefits of social living** and centre on respecting the **natural rights to life, liberty and property**.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
social contract	naming the theory in any application or case	**MUST**
natural rights: life, liberty, property	giving Locke's rights	**SHOULD**
sphere of freedom	explaining the contract	**SHOULD**
negative rights (liberties)	defining right to act without interference	**SHOULD**
positive rights (claim-rights)	defining an obligation of some to provide for others	**SHOULD**
language of rights	giving an argument for	**SHOULD**
conflicting rights problem	criticising the theory	**SHOULD**
incapable of following the rules	criticising the theory	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the definition from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Social contract theory: the idea.
Individuals implicitly accept a "social contract", on the condition that others follow the rules as well.

John Locke's three natural rights.
Life, liberty and property.

Negative rights (liberties).
The right to act without interference.

Positive rights (claim-rights).
An obligation of some people to provide certain things for others.

Three arguments for social contract theory.
Framed in the language of rights; without common agreement, rational people may act out of self-interest; provides clear analysis of certain government actions ("those who do not follow the rules will be punished").

Two arguments against social contract theory.
Conflicting rights problem; may be unjust to people who are incapable of following (not deliberately breaking) the rules.

Divine command theory

The idea (slide 32). Good actions are those aligned with the will of God, and bad actions are those contrary to the will of God. God's will has been revealed to us, so we can use the holy books as moral decision-making guides: the Torah for Judaism, the Bible for Christianity and the Koran for Islam.

Arguments for (slide 33).

- God is all-good, all-knowing and all-powerful. "We'd better do what he says!"
- God's authority is higher than any human-made ethical system.

Arguments against (slide 34).

- There are many different interpretations of God's word. Who is right?
- We live in a multicultural, secular society, so not everyone accepts the same book or any book.
- The holy books do not apply to modern technological issues. The Bible does not mention the Internet.
- It is based on obedience and duty, not on reason.

MARKER WORDS: DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

Say it like this:

> Divine command theory holds that **good actions are those aligned with the will of God** and **bad actions are those contrary to the will of God**, which is **revealed in the holy books**.

Vocabulary to weave into explanations:

Marker	Use it when you are...	Tag
will of God	defining the theory	**SHOULD**
holy books as moral decision-making guides	explaining how we know God's will (Torah, Bible, Koran)	**SHOULD**
all-good, all-knowing, all-powerful	giving an argument for	**SHOULD**
higher than human-made ethical system	giving an argument for	**SHOULD**
many different interpretations	criticising it	**SHOULD**
multicultural, secular society	criticising it	**SHOULD**
obedience, duty and not reason	criticising it	**SHOULD**

▶ **Recall drill: write the definition from memory, then click each blank to check**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

Divine command theory: the idea.
Good actions are those aligned with the will of God and bad actions are those contrary to the will of God.

The holy books named on the slide, by religion.
Judaism: Torah; Christianity: Bible; Islam: Koran.

Two arguments for divine command theory.
God is all-good, all-knowing, all-powerful; God's authority is higher than human-made ethical systems.

Four arguments against divine command theory.
Many different interpretations of God's word; we live in a multicultural, secular society; the holy books don't apply to modern technological issues (the Bible doesn't mention "Internet"); based on obedience, duty and not reason.

Past paper: which theory underlies each file-sharing argument?

This question asks you to match a statement to a theory and to say why. For each statement, name the theory in your first line, then quote its key idea and tie it to the words of the statement.

Q: **2016 Q5C · 10 marks** **Identify the ethical theory that underlies each of the following 5 arguments for or against unauthorized online file-sharing of music (Kazaa, Gnutella, etc.), and say why. (I) I don't have any problem with downloading per se, but am afraid it will cut into the money going to the artists, and eventually will hurt the quality of the music available. So people shouldn't do it. (II) The problem with downloading is, what would happen if everybody did it? Then the artists wouldn't make any money, and I think that's wrong. So I don't think anybody should do it. (III) It's okay for people to download music if it's from a big label or a big group, because they have lots of money anyway. I try never to download from local artists and real independents though, because they're already struggling as it is. (IV) People shouldn't download music because it's a form of stealing, and stealing is just wrong. (V) I think everybody should download music. It's the only way to break the monopoly of the record companies. Then maybe it would be a more democratic market for music again. [reconstructed from garbled scan]**

Set 1 discussion questions (slides 35-37)

The slides end with five discussion questions. They have no single correct answer, so the answers below show the shape of a good one: a clear position, a reason, and an example. Slides 36 and 37 (positive rights and their conflicts with negative rights) are answered inside the social contract section above.

Q: **Set 1 slide 35** **What are some examples of contemporary technology issues for which our society's moral guidelines seem to be nonexistent or unclear?**

Q: **Set 1 slide 35** **(Ethical vs legal) Can you give examples where an action may be legal but unethical, or vice versa?**

Q: **Set 1 slide 35** **Do (or should) organizations have ethics? If so, who makes them? And who are affected: employees, customers, the society?**

Q: **Set 1 slide 36** **Which of the following should be considered legitimate positive rights by our society: minimum standard of living, housing, health care, education, a paying job, two months of vacation each year?**

Q: **Set 1 slide 37** **Give examples of conflicts between the positive rights of one person and the negative rights of another.**

FLASHCARDS: CLICK TO FLIP

The seven ethical systems on slide 10.
Kantianism; utilitarianism; ethical egoism; subjective relativism; cultural relativism; social contract theory; divine command theory.